The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

28th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Uncharted (अबूझ/अज्ञात)

Meaning: Not previously explored, known, or experienced.
Synonyms: Unknown, unexplored, unmapped
Antonyms: Known, familiar, charted
Example: The explorers ventured into uncharted territory, unsure of what they would find.

2. Hitherto (अब तक)

Meaning: Until now or until the point in time under discussion.
Synonyms: So far, heretofore, until now
Example: Hitherto, the project had faced numerous challenges, but it is now on track.

VOCABULARY

3. Acquittal (बरी करना)

Meaning: A judgment that a person is not guilty of the crime they have been charged with.
Synonyms: Exoneration, clearance, vindication
Antonyms: Conviction, blame, punishment
Example: The court's acquittal of the accused brought relief to his family.

4. Ambushed (घात लगाकर हमला करना)

Meaning: Attacked suddenly and unexpectedly from a hidden position.
Synonyms: Waylaid, trapped, attacked
Antonyms: Averted, avoided, alerted
Example: The soldiers were ambushed by the enemy while crossing the dense forest.

VOCABULARY

5. Turmoil (अराजकता)

Meaning: A state of great disturbance, confusion, or uncertainty.
Synonyms: Chaos, upheaval, disorder
Antonyms: Peace, order, calm
Example: The country faced political turmoil after the unexpected resignation of the minister.

6. Thwarted (विफल करना)

Meaning: Prevented someone from accomplishing something.
Synonyms: Foiled, obstructed, hindered
Antonyms: Aided, facilitated, supported
Example: The bad weather thwarted their plans for an outdoor wedding.

VOCABULARY

7. Contentious (विवादास्पद)

Meaning: Causing or likely to cause an argument; controversial.
Synonyms: Disputed, debatable, argumentative
Antonyms: Agreeable, uncontested, harmonious
Example: The new law became a contentious issue among political leaders.

8. Abjured (त्याग करना)

Meaning: Formally renounced or rejected a belief, cause, or claim.
Synonyms: Renounced, repudiated, recanted, disavowed
Antonyms: Accepted, embraced, affirmed, declared
Example: Under pressure, the witness abjured his earlier testimony, claiming it was given under duress.

VOCABULARY

9. Blatant (स्पष्ट/बेशर्म)

Meaning: (Of bad behavior) done openly and unashamedly; very obvious.
Synonyms: Obvious, flagrant, conspicuous, overt
Antonyms: Subtle, discreet, inconspicuous
Example: His blatant disregard for the rules earned him a suspension from the team.

10. Dolorous (दुःखद)

Meaning: Feeling or expressing great sorrow or distress.
Synonyms: Sorrowful, mournful, melancholy, woeful
Antonyms: Cheerful, joyful, happy, jubilant
Example: The dolorous tone of the funeral brought tears to the eyes of everyone present.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Bawl out
Meaning - To scold someone severely.

2. Blare out
Meaning - To emit a loud and harsh sound, often referring to music or announcements.

3. Clown about
Meaning - To behave in a silly or playful manner.

4. Gag for
Meaning - To strongly desire or crave something.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Turn a blind eye

Meaning - to ignore something that you know is wrong

2. Read the riot act

Meaning - to chastise loudly, or to issue a severe warning

3. I've got it in the bag

Meaning - something is assured of success

VOCABULARY

4. Play fast and loose

Meaning - to behave in a clever and dishonest way

5. Tooth and nail

Meaning - to try very hard to get something you want

Article for Reading

Wide open: On the Australian Open

The 2025 Australian Open has pushed world tennis into hitherto uncharted territories. Jannik Sinner’s straight sets victory over Alexander Zverev made him the first man other than Roger Federer and Rafael Nadal to defend his maiden Major title this century. This, perhaps, is the clearest sign that the sport has decisively moved on, even as 24-time Slam winner Novak Djokovic, the last-man standing from the Big Three era, limped out of the semifinal against Zverev. Among women, Madison Keys may have become yet another first-time Major champion, but the presence of No.1 Aryna Sabalenka and No.2 Iga Swiatek at the business end shows that the women’s field is a maturing marketplace, leaving behind the turbulence of the past few years. Sinner’s success was his third straight in hard-court Slams. Such has been the World No.1’s dominance that of the 26 tournaments he has entered starting from the Toronto Masters in August 2023, he has won 14 and finished semifinalist or better in five others.

Keys, in contrast, was a bolt from the blue and had last reached a Major final at the 2017 US Open. But the fact that the 29-year-old overcame Swiatek in the semifinal after erasing a match-point and thwarted Sabalenka in the final despite a stirring comeback from the Belarusian made hers a top-drawer performance. While Sinner, on current form, appears head and shoulders above the rest of the Tour, he still has to contend with Carlos Alcaraz, his generational rival and winner of four Slams. The Spaniard may have lost in the quarterfinals to Djokovic, but he handed Sinner three of his six defeats in an otherwise sensational 2024 for the Italian. There is, however, a chance that this duel might come to an abrupt halt in April when the Court of Arbitration for Sport hears the appeal filed by World Anti-Doping Agency against Sinner's acquittal over two failed dope tests (March 2024).

Whether this saga gives the likes of Zverev and Daniil Medvedev an opening is another thing to watch out for. The two, who looked set to take over from the Big Three only to be ambushed by Sinner and Alcaraz, have collectively won just one of nine Major finals they have taken part in. Only a title in 2025 will keep them relevant. The women's game, which in recent times has traded predictability for novelty, might see the two aspects march in tow for the foreseeable future. Sabalenka's consistency, Swiatek's return — Melbourne was her best run at a Slam since January 2023 outside the French Open — and Keys' win point in that direction.

Summary

The 2025 Australian Open marked a significant shift in tennis, with Jannik Sinner and Madison Keys delivering standout performances. Sinner became the first man this century, outside Roger Federer and Rafael Nadal, to defend his maiden Grand Slam title, signaling a new era in men’s tennis. Sinner's dominance, with 14 titles in 26 tournaments since August 2023, is undeniable, although his rivalry with Carlos Alcaraz remains a key narrative. However, a pending doping case could affect his trajectory, potentially opening opportunities for Alexander Zverev and Daniil Medvedev, who have yet to achieve consistent success in Grand Slam finals. In the women’s tournament, Madison Keys claimed her first Major title, overcoming top players Aryna Sabalenka and Iga Swiatek. While Keys' victory was unexpected, Sabalenka’s consistency and Swiatek’s return to form suggest a maturing women's field that balances novelty with predictability. Both men's and women's tennis appear poised for exciting developments as new stars rise and established players adapt.

Tone:

The tone is analytical and forward-looking, assessing current trends in tennis while anticipating the future trajectories of key players and the sport as a whole.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
What is a key challenge that might impact Sinner's rivalry with Carlos Alcaraz in 2025?

a) Alcaraz's consistent victories over Sinner in 2024.
b) Sinner's declining performance on non-hard-court surfaces.
c) The appeal by the World Anti-Doping Agency regarding Sinner's acquittal.
d) Alcaraz's recovery from an injury sustained in the quarterfinals.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What does the phrase “maturing marketplace” imply about the state of women’s tennis?

a) It is becoming dominated by a few consistent players.
b) It is showing a balance between established players and emerging champions.
c) It is struggling to find a balance between novelty and consistency.
d) It has become unpredictable and volatile.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
Which of the following best captures the state of Zverev and Medvedev's careers as described in the passage?

a) They are strong contenders for the 2025 Australian Open title.
b) They are consistently outperforming Sinner and Alcaraz in Major finals.
c) They are expected to dominate the Tour in the absence of Djokovic.
d) Their relevance hinges on winning a Major title in 2025.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

First resort: On Donald Trump’s mass deportation drive

Donald Trump's mass deportation drive hit its first hurdle on Sunday (January 26, 2025) when Colombian President Gustavo Petro refused permission to two United States military planes carrying migrants to land. A furious Mr. Trump announced that the U.S. would impose a 25% tariff on all Colombian goods, which would be raised to 50%. The U.S. also threatened to impose banking and financial sanctions and issue travel bans on Colombian officials and associates. Mr. Petro, a former guerrilla, responded in kind by saying Colombia would also impose tariffs up to 50% on American goods and refused to "shake hands with white slaveholders". But Bogota, under pressure, eventually accepted to take back the migrants "with dignity and respect". A trade war would have been bad news for both countries whose bilateral trade stood at $53.5 billion in 2022, with a $4 billion surplus for the U.S. High tariffs would have been a body blow for Colombia, as the U.S. is its largest trading partner.

With tariffs and financial and political sanctions, America could cripple Colombia's economy and destabilise its polity at a time when its fight with guerrillas is escalating after a lull. Unsurprisingly, Mr. Petro backtracked and agreed to accept what the White House said was "all its terms". Colombia and other South American countries have been taking undocumented migrants back from the U.S. in recent years. In January, there were 90 deportation flights from the U.S. to its southern neighbours, eight of which landed in Colombia. But what turned a regular exercise into a controversy was the handling of the deportation by the Trump administration — the use of mostly military planes, which angered the Colombians. Mr. Petro also raised concerns about the way migrants were treated by the U.S. Earlier, Brazil had also raised complaints of "degrading treatment" of its deported citizens. They were handcuffed, and some of them were not given water or allowed to use the washroom during the flight, according to Brazilian officials. But Mr. Trump does not seem to care.

He wanted to make an example of Colombia so that other neighbours will not challenge his handling of the mass deportation. He may have forced Colombia to backtrack for now, using America's economic muscle, but this kind of coercion could backfire in the long run in a region where America has always tried to maintain its geopolitical hegemony. And the inhumane conditions in which hundreds of migrants are being deported everyday is a blot on America's tall claims of protecting human rights. A better way of handling this crisis is through diplomacy. Instead of imposing his will on other countries through threats of tariffs and sanctions, Mr. Trump could use the diplomatic channel, seek consensus and then implement his policy in a much more cordial way. But for Mr. Trump, alas, coercion is the first resort.

Question 4:
What is the author's perspective on Mr. Trump's handling of the deportation crisis?

a) It was necessary to use coercion to ensure compliance from neighboring countries.
b) It demonstrated effective leadership in addressing illegal migration.
c) It showcased America's commitment to maintaining its geopolitical hegemony.
d) It was unnecessarily coercive and likely to backfire in the long run.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
What does the author imply about the long-term consequences of Mr. Trump's policies in the region?

a) They could strengthen U.S. ties with South American nations.
b) They might undermine America's geopolitical influence in the region.
c) They would result in better treatment of migrants during deportation.
d) They would deter South American countries from challenging U.S. policies.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

Original text:

Inclusive growth refers to an economic growth model that ensures equitable opportunities and benefits for all segments of society, particularly the marginalized and underprivileged. Unlike conventional growth, which often leads to widening income gaps and regional disparities, inclusive growth emphasizes participation, sustainability, and equality, ensuring that the advantages of economic expansion are shared broadly. The core principles of inclusive growth include generating employment, reducing poverty, and enhancing access to education, healthcare, and essential services. It also prioritizes empowering women, promoting social inclusion, and fostering entrepreneurship at grassroots levels.

Governments and organizations play a pivotal role in creating policies and programs that target underdeveloped regions, bridge skill gaps, and support small and medium enterprises (SMEs) to ensure widespread economic participation. Inclusive growth offers multiple benefits. It creates a robust and sustainable economy by expanding the consumer base, reducing social unrest, and fostering political stability. When individuals from all economic backgrounds contribute to and benefit from growth, productivity increases, and innovation thrives. Moreover, inclusive growth is crucial for meeting global development goals, such as the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), which advocate for reduced inequalities and improved living standards for all. However, achieving inclusive growth requires overcoming challenges such as income inequality, gender disparities, and unequal access to opportunities. Policymakers must focus on creating inclusive institutions, ensuring transparency, and addressing structural barriers. By fostering participation across all societal strata, inclusive growth lays the foundation for a just, equitable, and sustainable future.

Precis

Inclusive growth ensures that economic expansion benefits all, especially marginalized groups, by emphasizing equality, employment, and access to essential services. It promotes social inclusion, reduces poverty, and empowers communities through targeted policies and programs. This growth model enhances economic sustainability, expands the consumer base, and supports global goals like the SDGs. While challenges like inequality and structural barriers persist, fostering participation across societal levels can create a just and sustainable future.

- **You recently received an incorrect bill from a company. Write an email to their support team highlighting the issue and requesting a revised bill.**

To: ……@gmail.com

Subject: Request for Correction of Incorrect Bill

Dear [Support Team/Recipient's Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to bring to your attention an issue with the bill I recently received from your company (Invoice Number: [Insert Invoice Number]). Upon reviewing the details, I noticed that the amount charged does not match the agreed terms or the services/products availed.

Specifically, the discrepancies are as follows:

[Mention the incorrect charges or details, e.g., "An extra service charge of $50 has been included, which was not applicable."]
[Highlight other discrepancies, if any.]

I would appreciate it if you could review this matter and issue a revised bill reflecting the correct amount. Please let me know if you need any additional information or documents to assist with the correction process.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter. I look forward to your response at the earliest convenience.

Best regards,
[Your Full Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Match the column

1. Turn a blind eye	A. to chastise loudly, or to issue a severe warning
2. Read the riot act	B. to behave in a clever and dishonest way
3. I've got it in the bag	C. to try very hard to get something you want
4. Play fast and loose	D. something is assured of success
5. Tooth and nail	E. to ignore something that you know is wrong

Answer:

1-e
2-a
3-d
4-b
5-c

Vocabulary

1. Uncharted:
2. Hitherto:
3. Acquittal:
4. Ambushed:
5. Turmoil:
6. Thwarted:
7. Contentious:
8. Abjured:
9. Blatant:
10. Dolorous:

RC ANS

1.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage mentions the pending hearing by the Court of Arbitration for Sport in April 2025, which could potentially disrupt Sinner’s career and his rivalry with Alcaraz.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) While Alcaraz did defeat Sinner three times in 2024, this is not framed as the main challenge in 2025.

b) No mention is made of Sinner struggling on other surfaces.

d) There is no indication that Alcaraz was injured during the quarterfinals.

2.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage uses “maturing marketplace” to describe how the women’s field has evolved to feature both consistency (Swiatek and Sabalenka) and novelty (Keys’ win), signaling a balanced competitive environment.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) While consistent players are present, the field is not dominated solely by them.
c) The passage suggests that the balance has been achieved, not that it is struggling.
d) It contrasts recent turbulence with the newfound balance.

3.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The passage states that Zverev and Medvedev, who were once seen as successors to the Big Three, have collectively won only one of nine Major finals they contested. Winning a title in 2025 is critical for their continued relevance.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) The passage does not suggest that they are favorites for the 2025 Australian Open.
b) Sinner and Alcaraz have outperformed them in recent years.
c) Sinner and Alcaraz are framed as the dominant figures, not Zverev and Medvedev.

4.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The author criticizes Mr. Trump’s reliance on coercion and economic threats, arguing that it could harm America’s long-term influence in the region. The passage also highlights the inhumane treatment of migrants and suggests diplomacy as a better alternative.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) The author suggests coercion was avoidable and counterproductive.
b) Leadership is not portrayed positively in the passage.
c) While geopolitical hegemony is mentioned, the tone is critical of how it was maintained.

5.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage warns that using threats and coercion could backfire and damage America’s long-standing efforts to maintain geopolitical hegemony in South America.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) The passage suggests that coercion could strain ties, not strengthen them.
c) The treatment of migrants is criticized, and no improvements are implied.
d) While short-term compliance is achieved, the long-term consequences could be negative.

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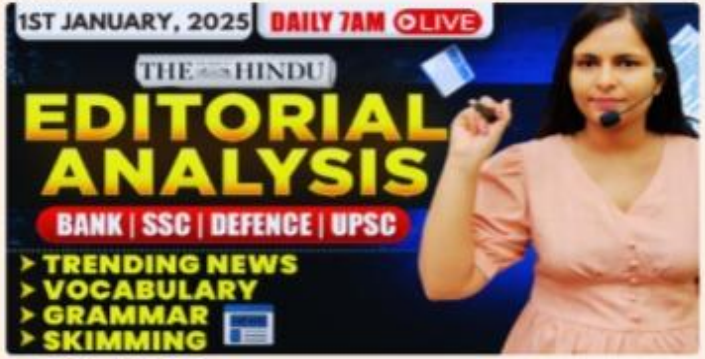

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